DBS AND CRIMINAL-OFFENCE DATA POLICY

Appropriate Policy Document and Retention Schedule | Opulence Bliss Ltd | Version 1.0 | Effective from: 1 October 2026

This policy explains how we handle the results of basic Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) checks and any other information about criminal convictions. It is our "appropriate policy document" under Schedule 1 of the Data Protection Act 2018 and forms part of our data protection records.

1. Who we are and what this policy covers

1.1 Opulence Bliss Ltd ("we", "us"), company number 15894675, 128 City Road, London, United Kingdom, EC1V 2NX, is the controller of the personal information described here. We are registered with the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) under number ZC264981. Contact: hello@opulencebliss.com.

1.2 This policy covers the **basic DBS certificates** that cleaners and handymen show us before they take bookings, and any information about unspent criminal convictions that they or others tell us.

1.3 Information about criminal convictions is called "criminal offence data" under Article 10 of the UK GDPR. It needs extra protection.

2. What we process

2.1 We ask each cleaner and handyman to apply for their own basic DBS check at https://www.gov.uk/request-copy-criminal-record and show us the certificate. A basic check shows only **unspent** convictions and conditional cautions.

2.2 We record: the person's name, the certificate number and date, whether it showed nothing or showed an unspent conviction, a short note of the decision we made and why, and the date we reviewed it.

2.3 We may keep a copy of the certificate only for the short period set out in section 7. We do not ask for, or use, more information about convictions than we need.

3. Why we process it

3.1 Our cleaners and handymen work alone in customers' homes and businesses, sometimes with children, older people or other vulnerable people. We use DBS results to:

- protect customers, their property and the public;
- prevent and detect unlawful acts, such as theft, fraud and violence; and
- decide whether a person is suitable to work through our platform.

3.2 We use the information only for these purposes. We do not use it for marketing or any unrelated purpose.

4. Our legal basis

4.1 **UK GDPR Article 6(1)(f), legitimate interests:** our interest in keeping customers and our cleaners and handymen safe and preventing crime. We have balanced this against the privacy of the person checked.

4.2 **Article 10 and Schedule 1 of the Data Protection Act 2018.** We rely on these conditions for processing criminal offence data:

- **Paragraph 10, preventing or detecting unlawful acts:** where we need to carry out the check without the person's consent in order to prevent or detect unlawful acts, and asking for consent would prejudice that purpose; and
- **Paragraph 11, protecting the public against dishonesty:** where we need to decide whether a person is suitable to work in customers' homes.

4.3 We also ask the person to confirm that they agree that we may see and record their certificate. A person who does not agree cannot take bookings through the platform.

5. How we follow the data protection principles

5.1 **Lawfulness, fairness and transparency.** We tell every applicant, in our terms and privacy notice, that we ask for a DBS check, why, and how we handle the result. A decision is never based on a conviction alone (see section 6).

5.2 **Purpose limitation.** We use DBS information only for the purposes in section 3.

5.3 **Data minimisation.** We ask only for a basic check, we look at the certificate, we record only the details in section 2.2, and we do not keep a long-term copy.

5.4 **Accuracy.** The information comes directly from the person's own certificate. If they tell us something has changed, we update our record. We ask for a fresh certificate where we need to.

5.5 **Storage limitation.** We keep DBS information only for the periods in section 7, and then delete it securely.

5.6 **Security.** Certificates and records are kept in a restricted, access-controlled and encrypted location. Only the people named in section 8 can see them. We do not share them with customers or other cleaners or handymen, and we do not send them by ordinary email where we can avoid it.

5.7 **Accountability.** We keep a record of this processing, review this policy every 12 months, and keep a log of who has accessed DBS records.

6. How we make decisions

6.1 A conviction does not automatically stop someone working with us. We look at each case on its facts, including how serious and how relevant the offence is to the work, how long ago it was, what the person has done since, and the safety of customers.

6.2 We give the person the chance to explain before we make a decision, and we make it ourselves, not by an automated system.

6.3 We tell the person our decision in writing and explain it. They can ask us to review it.

6.4 We follow the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974. We do not ask about, or take into account, convictions that are spent, where the law says we must not.

7. Retention schedule

- **Copy of the DBS certificate:** we look at it and delete the copy within **6 months** of the date we first saw it, unless we need it for a legal claim or investigation. It is then securely deleted.

- **Record of the check (name, certificate number and date, outcome, decision note):** kept while the person works with us, and for **6 months** after their account closes. It is then securely deleted.
- **Notes where we decided not to accept a person:** kept for **6 months** from our decision, in case the person challenges it. They are then securely deleted.
- **Anything needed for a legal claim, regulator or police request:** kept only for as long as that matter needs, then reviewed and deleted.

7.1 This policy is itself kept for **at least 6 months after** we stop processing this type of data, and is made available to the ICO on request.

8. Who can see it and who we share it with

8.1 Only the owner of the business and members of our onboarding team may see DBS information. The onboarding team carries out the checks. We authorise each team member in writing, keep a list of who they are, and tell each of them about this policy before they have access.

8.2 We do not share DBS information with customers, other cleaners or handymen, or businesses.

8.3 We share it only where the law requires or allows, for example with the police or another authority to prevent or detect crime, with a court, or with our insurers or advisers if needed for a claim. We do not sell it.

9. Your rights

9.1 You have the right to see your information, ask us to correct it, ask us to delete it, object to how we use it and ask us to restrict it, in line with UK data protection law. Some rights are limited where we must keep the information by law.

9.2 To use your rights, or if you are unhappy with how we handle your information, email hello@opulencebliss.com. We will acknowledge your complaint within 3 working days and reply without undue delay, and within 30 days in any case. You can also complain to the ICO at ico.org.uk or on 0303 123 1113.

10. Reviewing this policy

10.1 We review this policy at least once a year, and whenever our processing or the law changes. The current version is available to cleaners and handymen on request.

11. Contact us

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